■ THE DAILY GOODS STORY SCOUT - Wednesday, September 23, 2026

TODAY'S RUNDOWN SLOTS

THE LIST (5 stories)

■ *An Ohio solar farm is now home to more than 50 beehives and nearly 3 million honey bees, turning land around its panels into pollinator habitat while veteran beekeepers use the project to train other veterans and first responders.*

The Angle: *It's the ultimate two-birds-one-stone story — clean energy AND a pollinator boom — plus a genuinely moving twist: veterans are running the beehives and training other vets and first responders through it.*

- **50+ beehives** and nearly **3 million honey bees** now live on the grounds of one **Ohio solar farm**
- The space around the solar panels has been turned into a full **pollinator habitat**
- **Veteran beekeepers** are running the project and using it to train **other veterans and first responders**

The Watercooler Angle

- Solar farms doubling as bee sanctuaries — is this the future of every power project, or a one-off feel-good story?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.ecoticias.com/en/ohio-solar-farm-50-beehives-honey-bees/37148/

■ *264,000 New York City delivery workers will receive payments after DoorDash agreed to a $131.5 million settlement over underpaid and late pay. Every affected worker who was underpaid will receive at least $10, with DoorDash also agreeing to use the city's pay calculation going forward.*

The Angle: *DoorDash just got hit with a $131.5 million settlement for underpaying and delaying pay to NYC delivery workers — a huge number that taps into the bigger national conversation about gig workers getting squeezed by the apps that depend on them.*

- **264,000** NYC delivery workers are set to receive payments from the settlement
- DoorDash agreed to pay **$131.5 million** total
- Every underpaid worker gets **at least $10** back
- DoorDash also agreed to start using the **city's own pay calculation** going forward

The Debate Starter

- Would you even notice $10 missing per shift, or is this proof gig apps are nickel-and-diming workers at scale?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.businessinsider.com/doordash-nyc-settlement-admits-pay-errors-agrees-to-payout-2026-9

■ *Zelenskyy to address UN, Rubio to meet Russian counterpart — but few breakthroughs expected*

The Angle: *Zelenskyy takes the world stage at the UN today just as Russia hammers Kyiv with fresh drone strikes — brutal timing that underscores how far apart the two sides still are on ending the war.*

- **Russia** launched drone strikes on **Kyiv** Wednesday, hitting railway infrastructure, warehouses, and fuel stations
- **Volodymyr Zelenskyy** is set to address the **United Nations General Assembly** in New York the same day
- Secretary of State **Marco Rubio** is scheduled to meet with his **Russian counterpart**

- Despite the high-level diplomacy, few breakthroughs are expected from the talks

The Debate Starter

- Does high-stakes diplomacy even matter anymore when the bombs don't stop for it?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/world/unga-zelenskyy-rubio-lavrov-russia-ukraine-war-9.7354849?cmp=rss

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🛩■ *Hero pilot Sully Sullenberger reveals his biggest fear of Alzheimer's battle*

The Angle: *Sully Sullenberger — the pilot who became a national hero for landing that plane on the Hudson River — is now revealing he's facing Alzheimer's, and doing it with the same defiant grit that made him famous.*

- Captain **Chesley 'Sully' Sullenberger**, the pilot who safely landed **US Airways Flight 1549** on the Hudson River, has opened up about battling **Alzheimer's**.
- On his biggest fear, he vowed: **"if this has to be my last flight, I'm going to go out using a full afterburner."**

The Human Interest Hook

- A national hero facing his toughest fight yet with zero self-pity — what's the moment someone you admire showed you how to handle bad news?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/09/23/us-news/hero-pilot-sully-sullenberger-reveals-his-biggest-fear-of-alzheimers-battle/

■ *Body of missing grandmother found stuffed in a suitcase dropped off at fire station*

The Angle: *This is the kind of true-crime-meets-real-life story that stops a scroll cold — a beloved grandmother goes missing, and days later two people literally wheel her body up to a fire station in a suitcase. It's bizarre, it's tragic, and it's now a homicide investigation.*

- Victim identified as **Lorretta Moody**, a Kansas grandmother reported missing
- Two people dropped a suitcase off at a **Wichita fire station** on **Sept. 16** and told staff there was a body inside
- Police are investigating the death as a **homicide**
- Case remains under active investigation — no arrests confirmed yet in available reporting

The Debate Starter

- Who drops a body off at a fire station instead of just calling it in — guilt, panic, or something colder?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/09/23/us-news/body-of-missing-grandmother-lorretta-moody-found-in-suitcase/

Backup options:

■ *Trump says U.S. to continue buying Canadian potash but wants cheaper price*

The Angle: *It's a trade story with a grocery-bill punchline: potash is a key fertilizer ingredient, so how this shakes out could ripple into food prices on both sides of the border.*

- **Trump** says the U.S. will **keep buying** Canadian potash
- But he wants Canada to sell it at a **cheaper price**
- Potash is a critical ingredient in **fertilizer**, tying this to farming and food costs
- Comes amid the broader back-and-forth on **U.S.-Canada trade**

The Debate Starter

- Is 'we'll keep buying, just make it cheaper' smart negotiating or just Trump being Trump on trade?

CTV News (via Google News) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMiwwFBVV95cUxQdUVTUV9HTzJ3U1lKakdMajdoSFdJZ0hMRUl6aUNWS2lSY29oV1pfU1AtWXRQbHFheFZXX3VaU0FWM0ZaOFRiT0VhcFFwUXM5Vjd5N1lRMEgzOGtFOWpKRTl4dl9LV1N1VkdZLUNEX2o2cFhUblEybk9HbGRXTlZLc3Jxckt2XzRLSnV4cmJ4QkU0bExUZzU2LTM5QkNHd2dnVjRncFYzZDFsYXpwTzE2RnNYMTg5OTZXeDk1Y01RQVp5bE0?oc=5

■ *Carney promises $100 million for Palestinians in humanitarian aid, police training*

The Angle: *Canada's PM is putting real money behind the Israel-Hamas ceasefire push, and it's a window into how Ottawa wants to be seen on the world stage right now.*

- **Mark Carney** announced **$100 million** in new funding for Palestinians
- The money is earmarked for **humanitarian aid** and **police training**
- The pledge comes via **CTV News** reporting on Carney's commitment

The Debate Starter

- Should Canada be spending $100 million abroad right now, or is that money better spent at home?

CTV News (via Google News) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMivgFBVV95cUxNVWpfZHpQT09ib2I5bWFPSms5bkhlbFgwYnpQWlR5c2tTdy10dk5VUjl1d09ITTdFMTJIMGRXVXYxU0Fib1E0U0UtdHdKRWFHVGJDR29qYjZmVnJ2ZFBnTVdaQVQwdWotOEtVa0dzZmp2QktFVXBrVTRUcnFNaVAtV3UxcmdrOHBZZGdGY0Nyakg1Q2VxZnAwOGd2NHBMVnd4OUNtd05CRlZUMWZqWHFTdEpMdnBGNnVXRWQ3c2ZB?oc=5

■ *Matthew McConaughey Exposed Himself to Jimmy Kimmel in Emmys Bathroom - Variety*

The Angle: *A Hollywood A-lister, a bathroom, and a late-night confession — this is exactly the kind of unhinged celebrity story that blows up online and gives hosts an easy, funny cold open.*

- **Jimmy Kimmel** told the story on Monday's episode of **"Jimmy Kimmel Live"**
- Kimmel claims **Matthew McConaughey** comforted him backstage at the **Emmys** with his "member out"
- The bit came right after Kimmel's usual monologue jabs at **President Trump**

The Debate Starter

- Is this a top-five celebrity-encounter story of the year, or has Kimmel officially jumped the shark with his monologues?

Variety (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/tv/news/matthew-mcconaughey-exposed-jimmy-kimmel-emmys-bathroom-woody-harrelson-1236871737/

CANADIAN NEWS (3 stories)

■ *Tariffs drive Canadian sales of U.S.-made vehicles to new lows*

The Angle: *The trade fight with the U.S. isn't just political noise anymore — it's showing up on car lots, with Canadians turning away from American-made vehicles in record numbers.*

- Sales of **U.S.-made vehicles** in Canada have reportedly fallen to their **lowest levels** on record.
- The drop lines up with the ongoing **Canada-U.S. tariff dispute** that's been rattling cross-border trade all year.
- It's the latest sign of a broader **"Buy Canadian"** consumer shift showing up at the checkout — or in this case, the dealership.

The Debate Starter

- Have you personally skipped a U.S. brand at the dealership because of the tariff fight?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.autonews.com/retail/anc-tariffs-canadian-sales-us-origin-decline-0922/

■ *Canada leaving billions on the table by not processing more crops at home, new agri-food study says | CBC News*

The Angle: *A new agri-food study says Canada is basically exporting the profit along with the wheat and canola — sending raw crops overseas instead of turning them into finished food and ingredients at home, which means we're leaving jobs and revenue on the table.*

- New **agri-food study** finds Canada is missing out on **billions of dollars** by not processing more of its own crops domestically

- The gap is about **raw crop exports** (think grain, canola, pulses) versus **value-added processing** happening here at home
- The debate centers on why the finished-product jobs and profits are going elsewhere instead of staying in Canada

The Debate Starter

- Should Canada be forcing more crop processing at home, or is shipping raw and letting other countries finish the job just smart trade?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/saskatchewan/canada-losing-billions-not-processing-crops-home-study-9.7353597

■ *Canada's Mexico visa requirements limit country's tourism potential, says tour operator*

The Angle: *Ottawa is eyeing Mexico as a huge untapped tourism market, but a tour operator says our own visa rules are the roadblock keeping those travelers - and their dollars - away.*

- The federal government projects visits from Mexico will jump **40%** over the next four years
- By **2030**, that's nearly **half a million** Mexican tourists coming to Canada annually
- Those visitors could be worth about **$1 billion a year** to the Canadian economy
- A tour operator argues Canada's **visa requirement** for Mexican travelers is capping that growth before it starts

The Debate Starter

- Should Canada scrap the visa requirement for Mexican tourists to cash in on a billion-dollar opportunity, or is that red tape there for a reason?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/world/mexico-tourism-canada-9.7354784?cmp=rss

Backup options:

■ *Robert Pattinson's Primetime hates Chris Hansen*

The Angle: *Robert Pattinson trading the Batman cowl for a dark comedy that takes direct shots at Chris Hansen is exactly the kind of weird, buzzy pop culture collision that gets people talking - a movie star roasting a tabloid TV fixture.*

- **Robert Pattinson** stars in **Primetime**, a new dark comedy series
- Critics are calling it **chaotic**, **spiralling**, and **off-putting**
- The show takes direct aim at **Chris Hansen**, the former face of **"To Catch a Predator"**

The Debate Starter

- Is it fair game for a comedy to torch a real TV personality like Chris Hansen, or does that cross a line?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/entertainment/primetime-review-9.7354596?cmp=rss

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■ *A nation renamed stands up at the UN: 'Say our name. Naoero.'*

The Angle: *A country stood up at the United Nations and flat-out told the world to drop its old name and use its own instead — a small moment with a big identity story behind it, the kind of thing that gets people talking about how many places we still call by names that aren't really theirs.*

The Debate Starter

- What place, brand, or even person's name have you been mispronouncing or miscalling for years without realizing it?

CTV News (via Google News) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMimgFBVV95cUxQVkhDU2toVl9hUGJkWGNON0U1V2Q5SGVtdEZlUzgzVzdFWUFOU1Z4V3dJZWZnQzFwbnZ0cUVjTFN1Zm4wVXpyYl9lbXNVYk04SFVIOXVyOHZkVXNPUTdOMWZ2SV95ZWEzLU5YU3gwYm9MbXlvT0x1OEh5dVlkUnQ4eURKcTJFdW1vREJQZFBxeEVkOGJ5YV9fTXBB?oc=5

■ *PM Carney touts ‘fertilizer independence’ as Trump says U.S. will keep buying Canadian potash. Live updates here.*

The Angle: *A trade flashpoint just cooled off - Trump publicly commits to keep buying Canadian potash while Carney spins it as a win for Canadian 'fertilizer independence,' right in the middle of ongoing trade tension between the two countries.*

- **PM Mark Carney** is framing the moment as a step toward Canadian **'fertilizer independence.'**
- **President Trump** says the **U.S. will keep buying Canadian potash** - a key farming input.
- Story is developing with live updates as of today.

The Debate Starter

- Is this actually a Canadian trade win, or just Trump stating the obvious because the U.S. has no other real potash supplier?

CTV News (via Google News) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMirgFBVV95cUxPbkdOSXB6aVYxNkNqbWYydlJIQWdYUjRWeGd5UVNsTFhTTEtNbnpRcGlKd3p6WFEyMUlOUzdEU0Z4WlJpc3BhZk43clVORF9zOFR5eVdPMkdhZTZmVDZvSnZQRWFVd2tBc1pmbUFURFVlUkRYbXR5YzRjTURjaU9BZzFfS2toeFZQVk9UaWd3OWduOWlFcE1aWk9fZXllbThzR1Y2dDYtS196NkJSSEE?oc=5

ENTERTAINMENT (4 stories)

■ *‘You Can See Everything’ Trailer: Nathan Fielder Lives With Elizabeth Holmes, Makes Her Cry and Interrogates Her Husband in Documentary*

The Angle: *A24 just dropped the trailer for Nathan Fielder's insanely secretive Elizabeth Holmes documentary, and the premise alone is wild — he reportedly lived with her during her last days of freedom and first weeks in prison. It's the kind of awkward-meets-serious concept that's already got awards season buzzing.*

- The doc is called **'You Can See Everything'** and comes from **Nathan Fielder** and **Lance Oppenheim**.
- It's a hefty **174 minutes** long.
- It follows **Theranos** founder **Elizabeth Holmes** through her final days of freedom and first weeks of imprisonment.
- The trailer reportedly shows Fielder making Holmes cry and grilling her husband on camera.

The Debate Starter

- Is this brilliant access journalism or is Nathan Fielder just exploiting an awkward-comedy bit for a convicted fraudster's story?

variety.com (Tier 2) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/film/news/you-can-see-everything-trailer-nathan-fielder-elizabeth-holmes-1236856369/

■■ *The one person Dolly Parton allowed at her deathbed revealed*

The Angle: *New details are surfacing about Dolly Parton's private final moments after her secret cancer battle - the kind of intimate reveal fans latch onto because it shows the real woman behind the rhinestones.*

- **Dolly Parton**, the "**Jolene**" icon, passed away on **Aug. 25** at age **80**
- She had been quietly fighting **cancer**, keeping the diagnosis out of the public eye
- A new report reveals the identity of the one person she allowed at her deathbed

The Heart-Tug

- It says a lot about someone when you find out who they wanted in the room at the very end.

pagesix.com (Tier 2) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://pagesix.com/2026/09/23/celebrity-news/the-one-person-dolly-parton-allowed-at-her-deathbed-revealed/

■ *NY Mayor Zohran Mamdani Blasts Paramount-WBD Deal As “Shameful Monument To Corruption”*

The Angle: *A sitting mayor going scorched-earth on a corporate media merger is a wild crossover of politics and Hollywood drama - it's the kind of quote that gets clipped and shared everywhere, which is exactly why it's blowing up right now.*

- **NYC Mayor Zohran Mamdani** publicly slammed the **Paramount-Warner Bros. Discovery** deal.
- He called it a **"shameful monument to corruption."**
- The comments put a local politician directly in the middle of one of the biggest media merger stories going.

The Debate Starter

- Should a mayor even be weighing in on a Hollywood mega-merger - or is this exactly the kind of corporate power move politicians should be calling out?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://deadline.com/2026/09/zohran-mamdani-blasts-paramount-wbd-deal-donald-trump-1237110847/

■ *'Digger' First Reactions Split Over Tom Cruise's 'Baffling,' 'Unpleasant' and 'Brave' New Movie: 'The Divide on This Is Going to Be Wide'*

The Angle: *Tom Cruise doesn't usually split a room this hard - early reactions to his new film 'Digger' are all over the map, from 'brave' to flat-out 'unpleasant,' which is exactly the kind of pile-on that gets people curious enough to see it themselves.*

- First reactions to **'Digger'** are already clashing hard.
- Critics are throwing around words like **'baffling,' 'unpleasant,'** and **'brave'** for the same movie.
- One reaction warns: **'The divide on this is going to be wide.'**

The Debate Starter

- Does a movie that splits critics this badly make you MORE curious to see it, or is that just a red flag?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/film/news/digger-first-reactions-tom-cruise-baffles-1236871935/

Backup options:

■ *Taylor Swift announces major music release after 'Patient Zero' news*

The Angle: *Swift just dropped the title of a brand-new track right after fans were still buzzing over the reveal, and now she's teasing an even bigger music announcement — classic Swift rollout that has the internet in full detective mode.*

- **Taylor Swift** revealed a new song titled **"Patient Zero"**
- The Grammy winner followed that reveal with a tease of a **major music announcement**
- Fans and outlets are already speculating on what the title could mean for the new era

The Theory Corner

- What do you think 'Patient Zero' is actually about — call in with your theory.

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://pagesix.com/2026/09/23/entertainment/taylor-swift-announces-the-life-of-a-showgirl-the-encore-album/

■ *Colleen Hoover and Michael Showalter on How Anne Hathaway and Dakota Johnson Made 'Verity' More Erotic, 'It Ends With Us' Drama and Sex in Movies*

The Angle: *Colleen Hoover is the biggest name in book-to-movie adaptations right now, and this interview spills on how her steamiest thriller got even steamier on screen - plus a nod to the messy 'It Ends With Us' press tour drama everyone's still talking about.*

- **Colleen Hoover** has sold over **35 million copies** worldwide across her novels
- Her books turned movies include **"It Ends with Us," "Verity,"** and **"Reminders of Him"**
- Director **Michael Showalter** and Hoover discuss how **Anne Hathaway** and **Dakota Johnson** made the "Verity" adaptation more erotic

- The interview also touches on the fallout from **"It Ends With Us"** and how sex is handled in movies today

The Debate Starter

- Do steamy book adaptations actually work better on screen, or does Hollywood always chicken out on the spicy parts?

variety.com (Tier 2) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 25 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/film/features/verity-colleen-hoover-anne-hathaway-dakota-johnson-erotic-1236872986/

■ *Brad Bird's 'Ray Gunn' Looks Like a Sci-Fi Detective Delight*

The Angle: *The Incredibles and Ratatouille director hasn't made an animated film in over a decade, and now he's landing one straight on Netflix with A-list star power attached — that's a big deal for animation fans and a streaming win worth talking about.*

- Directed by **Brad Bird** — the mind behind **The Incredibles** and **Ratatouille**
- Voice cast includes **Sam Rockwell** and **Scarlett Johansson**
- It's a sci-fi detective story, a genre mashup animation rarely tackles
- Drops on **Netflix** this **December**

The Anticipation Check

- Is a Brad Bird movie an automatic must-watch for you, no trailer needed?

gizmodo.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://gizmodo.com/brad-birds-ray-gunn-looks-like-a-sci-fi-detective-delight-2000815715

■ *Robert Eggers Has His Next Movie and It's Not Something You'd Ever Guess*

The Angle: *Robert Eggers just built his whole career on gothic dread — witches, vampires, now a werewolf movie — so pivoting straight to Shakespeare is the kind of swerve that makes film nerds and casual fans alike go 'huh, actually interesting.'*

- **Robert Eggers**, the director behind **'The Witch,' 'The Lighthouse,'** and **'Nosferatu,'** is following up his werewolf film **'Werwulf'** with a **Shakespeare** adaptation.
- Eggers has built his reputation as a **history-obsessed** filmmaker, known for meticulous period detail in horror and folklore-driven stories.

The Guessing Game

- Which Shakespeare play do you think fits Eggers' brooding, gothic style — and would you actually go see it?

gizmodo.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://gizmodo.com/robert-eggers-has-his-next-movie-and-its-not-something-youd-ever-guess-2000815722

TRENDING TODAY

■ *Travis Kelce shares reaction to Taylor Swift's ring-pointing 'that's my husband' viral moment https://t.co/gnOLEQN5EV https://t.co/ekqxLCxcn*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): This rides an already-viral Travis Kelce/Taylor Swift moment mid-momentum, and content tethered to Swift's fanbase has an unusually high ceiling for late breakout engagement.

The Angle: *Taylor Swift pointed to her ring and mouthed 'that's my husband' in a moment that instantly went viral, and now Travis Kelce is weighing in - prime tabloid catnip for the internet's favorite couple.*

- **Taylor Swift** was caught on camera pointing to her ring and mouthing '**that's my husband**' - and it instantly went viral.
- **Travis Kelce** has now publicly reacted to the clip, according to the **New York Post**.
- Exact details of Kelce's reaction weren't included in the source clip - worth pulling up video before air.

The Couple Watch

- Is Swift/Kelce still the most-talked-about couple in America, or is the public getting oversaturated?

X/Twitter @NYPost (Tier 1) | Score: 80/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 23 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://x.com/nypost/status/2102740833300631994

Backup options:

■ *Meta's Muse Could Become Most Widely Used Consumer AI App Since ChatGPT, JPMorgan Says — BofA Sees Improving AI Return Sentiment - Yahoo Finance*

The Angle: *Wall Street is buzzing that Meta's new AI app, Muse, could be the biggest consumer AI hit since ChatGPT — which matters because it's proof Meta's massive AI spending might actually start paying off.*

- **Muse** is currently the **No. 1 free app** in Apple's U.S. App Store.
- It's holding a **4.9-star rating** across more than **25,000 reviews**, per a BofA note.
- **JPMorgan** just reiterated an **'Overweight' rating** on Meta, citing Muse's momentum.
- Analysts say it could unlock new revenue through **subscriptions, advertising**, and more.

The Watercooler Take

- Have you even heard of Muse — or is this proof we're all missing the next big app before it's suddenly everywhere?

Stocktwits.com (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 73/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 16 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://stocktwits.com/news-articles/markets/equity/meta-s-muse-could-become-most-widely-used-consumer-ai-app-since-chat-gpt-jp-morgan-says-bof-a-sees-improving-ai-return-sentiment/cZMP8SDRBep

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■ *With new Macs, Apple aims to take on Microsoft, Nvidia in a rush to lower AI costs - Yahoo Finance*

The Angle: *Apple's making an unusually blunt pitch straight to corporate buyers: our new AI hardware is cheaper than Microsoft and Nvidia's — a rare direct shot in the trillion-dollar AI arms race that could shake up how businesses everywhere buy their tech.*

- Apple's new desktop computers start **shipping Tuesday**
- Company executives are making an **unusual direct pitch to corporate buyers**
- The core sales pitch: Apple's new Macs are **cheaper** than rival AI options from **Microsoft** and **Nvidia**
- Reported by **Reuters' Stephen Nellis** out of **San Francisco**

The Tech Debate Starter

- Would you trust Apple over Nvidia to run your business's AI — or is 'cheaper' just Apple's way of saying 'we're late to the party'?

Yahoo Entertainment (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 73/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 16 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://finance.yahoo.com/technology/ai/articles/macs-apple-aims-microsoft-nvidia-130118449.html

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LIFESTYLE CHAT

■ *People with clinical levels of love addiction experience more severe relationship anxiety than those who are simply at risk. Study finds that love addiction exists on a spectrum where intense attachment anxiety marks the transition into a clinical problem.*

The Angle: *Everyone jokes about being a 'love addict,' but this new study says there's an actual clinical line - and the marker that pushes someone over it is pure relationship-anxiety overload. It's a fun mirror-check topic that'll get both hosts and callers self-diagnosing live.*

- New research finds **love addiction** isn't all-or-nothing - it sits on a **spectrum**
- People at the **clinical level** show noticeably worse relationship anxiety than those just flagged as 'at risk'
- The study points to **intense attachment anxiety** as the tipping point that turns a risk factor into a full clinical issue

The Self-Check Moment

- Callers: has a partner ever told you that you love 'too hard' or 'too much' - and did you actually agree with them?

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 86/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.psypost.org/psychologists-pinpoint-the-dividing-line-between-problematic-romance-and-severe-love-addiction/

Backup options:

■ *Singapore is planting 1 million more trees by 2030 as research shows well placed shade can cut outdoor heat stress by up to 5°C. Measurements in the city found shaded locations provided significant relief during extreme heat, while models suggest trees could also reduce summer cooling energy use.*

The Angle: *It's a simple, feel-good fix for a real problem everyone's dealing with — brutal heat — and the science backing it up is surprisingly specific.*

- **Singapore** plans to plant **1 million more trees** by **2030**
- Well-placed shade can cut outdoor heat stress by up to **5°C**
- City measurements found shaded spots gave real relief during extreme heat
- Models suggest the trees could also cut **summer cooling energy use**

The Debate Starter

- Would you rather your city spent money on more trees or more AC subsidies?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.ecoticias.com/en/singapore-million-trees-heat-shade/37014/

■ *One in Three Gen Z Men Hasn't Masturbated in 90 Days*

The Angle: *It's the kind of headline that stops you mid-scroll and demands a reaction — a wild stat about young guys and, uh, personal time, that's basically built for a live debate about what's actually going on with Gen Z right now (stress? porn burnout? just memes?).*

- The claim: **1 in 3 Gen Z men** reportedly haven't masturbated in **90 days**.
- Originally flagged on **r/nottheonion**, the subreddit for real headlines too weird to believe.
- No underlying study details in this snippet — treat the number as a conversation starter, not gospel.

The Debate Starter

- Phones open: guys, is this real, and ladies, does this track with what you're seeing — call in and defend or debunk the stat.

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.playboy.com/read/sex-relationships/gen-z-sex-survey-masturbation

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CLOSER: THE KICKER/GOODBYES

■ *Some barbecue restaurants are pulling brisket and ribs from their menus due to high beef prices*

The Angle: *BBQ joints are yanking brisket and ribs off the menu because beef prices have gotten so brutal it's not pencilling out anymore - and if it's hitting the smokehouse, it's hitting your grocery cart too.*

- Some **barbecue restaurants** are reportedly **pulling brisket and ribs** from their menus entirely
- The culprit: **high beef prices** squeezing margins on the two most beef-heavy items on the board
- Story's gaining traction on **r/nottheonion** - the 'this can't be real but it is' subreddit

The Debate Starter

- Would you still hit up a barbecue spot if brisket's off the menu, or is that the whole reason you go?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.kgns.tv/2026/09/22/some-barbecue-restaurants-are-pulling-brisket-ribs-their-menus-due-high-beef-prices/

Backup options:

■ *EPA to begin screening U.S. drinking water for traces of abortion pills*

The Angle: *It sounds like a headline from a satire site, which is exactly why it's blowing up on r/nottheonion - the idea of the EPA screening America's drinking water for trace amounts of abortion medication is the perfect storm of science, politics, and 'wait, is this real?'*

- The **EPA** is reportedly planning to begin screening **U.S. drinking water** for trace amounts of **abortion pills**
- The story is circulating out of **r/nottheonion**, a subreddit dedicated to real headlines that sound too absurd to be true

The 'Wait, Is This Real?' Moment

- Guess the headline: real EPA policy or satire - can your co-host tell the difference?

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- **Step 1: Real or Onion?** - 60-second guessing bit -> Read the headline cold to your co-host without context and have them guess if it's real news or a satire headline before you reveal it's actually true
- **Step 2: Open the phones** - Quick audience reaction -> Ask listeners to text in whether they'd want to know if this was actually in their water supply

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.themirror.com/news/us-news/epa-begin-screening-us-drinking-2034312

FLEX (cap check: THE GREAT DEBATE 1/5 this month; TECH TALK 3/3 this month; Advice/Relationship Cluster 4/3 this month)

(no flex-slot candidates cleared the cap/score bar today)

BREAKOUT WATCH (below the show's usual engagement bar - included on editorial judgment, not metrics; producer's call)

■ *EXCLUSIVE: The Princess Margaret Cancer Foundation just received $100 million donation from an anonymous donor.*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): A single anonymous $100M gift to a cancer charity is a rare, clean 'who did this?' mystery paired with a massive round number, which tends to generate its own secondary coverage as people speculate on the donor.

The Angle: *A single anonymous gift of $100 million to a cancer foundation is the kind of only-good-news story listeners eat up — no scandal, no catch, just a stunning act of generosity to close out the show.*

- The **Princess Margaret Cancer Foundation** received a **$100 million donation**
- The donor has chosen to remain **completely anonymous**
- It's being reported as one of the **largest single gifts** the cancer foundation has ever received

The Feel-Good Finisher

- If you had $100 million to give away anonymously, where would it go?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cp24.com/local/toronto/2026/09/22/exclusive-the-princess-margaret-cancer-foundation-just-received-a-100-million-donation-from-an-anonymous-donor/

■ *OpenAI Hires AI Trainers, Then Fires Them for Using AI to Train AI: 'Getting Paid to Make AI Worse'*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): OpenAI firing human AI trainers for secretly using AI to do their job is a perfect, quotable irony ('getting paid to make AI worse') that plays directly into the AI-backlash zeitgeist and is very meme-able.
The Angle: *The ultimate 'well, duh' irony story - a company that literally sells AI catches its human trainers using AI to cheat at the job of training AI, then cans them for it.*

- **OpenAI** reportedly hired workers specifically to train its AI models
- Some of those trainers got caught using **AI tools** to do the training work for them
- The workers were **fired** once discovered - Reddit's r/nottheonion summed it up as 'getting paid to make AI worse'

The Irony Alert

- If your job is teaching the robot, is it cheating to let the robot teach itself?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.techtimes.co.uk/chatgpt-contractors-fired-using-ai-1808760

■ *Google using search and YouTube history to guess Canadians' ages and could make them show ID*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Google using search/YouTube history to age-verify Canadians taps into the fast-growing global age-verification/ID backlash and pairs a trusted big name with a surveillance angle that reliably outperforms.
The Angle: *Google is reportedly using Canadians' search and YouTube activity to estimate their age — and if it thinks you're a minor, you could get locked out until you prove your age with ID. It's a wild privacy trade-off: use AI surveillance of your habits to "protect" you, then demand your ID anyway.*

- **Google** is reportedly analyzing **search and YouTube history** to estimate whether a user is a minor.
- Users flagged by the system could be required to **verify their age with ID** to keep full access.
- The rollout is specific to **Canadian users** according to the report.

The Debate Starter

- Would you rather hand Google your ID, or have it quietly profile your browsing habits to guess your age for you?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.dexerto.com/youtube/google-using-search-and-youtube-history-to-guess-canadians-ages-and-could-make-them-show-id-3411331/

■■ *Meta's New Muse AI Agent Read My Private iMessages. I Never Asked It To*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): A first-person 'Meta's AI read my private iMessages without me asking' account is a visceral, personal privacy-violation narrative attached to a major brand, the exact combo that tends to escape its original subreddit.
The Angle: *A user says Meta's new **Muse** AI agent went digging through their private iMessages without being asked — exactly the kind of creepy-AI-overreach story that taps into everyone's fear about how much these assistants can actually see.*

- Story centers on **Meta's new Muse AI agent**
- User claims the AI read their **private iMessages**
- They say they **never asked it to** access those messages

The Debate Starter

- Would you trust an AI assistant with access to your private texts — or is this the moment you delete the app?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.inc.com/jason-aten/metas-new-muse-ai-agent-read-my-private-messages-i-never-asked-it-to/91408202

■ *Country song beats Mariah Carey tune for U.S. chart record https://t.co/1FHMbEwC5l*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): A country song dethroning a long-standing Mariah Carey chart record is a clean, surprising 'record broken' hook with a globally recognizable name that music and general-news audiences both latch onto.

The Angle: *Mariah's Christmas classic is basically chart royalty, so any song knocking off one of her U.S. chart records is an instant music-nerd flex — and it's country, not pop, doing the dethroning.*

- A **country song** has broken a **U.S. chart record** previously held by a **Mariah Carey** track
- Specific song title and chart details weren't included in the source snippet

The Debate Starter

- Country crossing over to break a pop icon's record — is country having its biggest chart moment yet, or is Mariah still untouchable?

X/Twitter @CTVNews (Tier 1) | Score: 72/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 15 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://x.com/CTVNews/status/2102578790933155860

FRANCHISE BANK

WHAT THE FRIDAY: 4 banked (+15 each when found)
- "Tiny mouse brawl breaks out on London subway platform" (nypost.com, banked 2026-09-08)
- "Dramatic video shows naked man being pulled from East River by NYC cops" (nypost.com, banked 2026-09-09)
- "Lady wtf, your kid is right there!" (X/Twitter @WomenBeingAwful, banked 2026-09-16)
- "Channing Tatum addresses claims he trolled ex Zoë Kravitz online using burner account: ‘Wtf come on’" (Entertainment Weekly (via Google News), banked 2026-09-22)

THROWBACK THURSDAY: 18 banked (+15 each when found)
- "Here’s Why Fifth Harmony Fans Think the Girl Group Is Making a Comeback Ahead of Anniversary" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-09-06)
- "Rachael Leigh Cook surprises fans at ‘Josie and the Pussycats’ 25th anniversary screening" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-09-07)
- "Stevie Wonder Announces ‘Songs in the Key of Life’ 50th Anniversary Tour https://t.co/trmKJsgwqb" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-09-08)
- "Michael Goodwin: Mamdani’s toxic Ground Zero blame game just latches on to still-open 9/11 wounds to boost himself" (nypost.com, banked 2026-09-08)
- "John Oliver to Host Comic Relief Live’s 40th Anniversary Show" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-09-09)
- "Where I was on 9/11: 4 people in N.L. share their stories of stepping up to help" (www.cbc.ca, banked 2026-09-11)
- "Gander mayor reflects on 25th anniversary of 9/11" (CTV News (via Google News), banked 2026-09-11)
- "Globe editorial: Nostalgia is no strategy for U.S. relations" (The Globe and Mail (via Google News), banked 2026-09-11)
- "Universal Studios Japan Celebrates Halloween With First R-Rated Attraction" (gizmodo.com, banked 2026-09-13)
- "‘Practical Magic 2’ Dazzles Up a Bit Of an Audience" (gizmodo.com, banked 2026-09-14)
- "The London revival of “Sunday in the Park With George” has been canceled following the exits of stars Ariana Grande and Jonathan Bailey." (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-09-14)
- "'Sunday in the Park With George' London Revival Canceled After Ariana Grande, Jonathan Bailey Exits https://t.co/cPQ2IIvYql" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-09-14)
- "‘Sunday in the Park With George’ revival scrapped after Ariana Grande, Jonathan Bailey exits" (Entertainment Weekly (via Google News), banked 2026-09-14)
- "Margot Robbie stuns in a retro bikini as she joins shirtless Bradley Cooper to shoot the Ocean's Eleven 1960s prequel on the French Riviera" (www.dailymail.co.uk, banked 2026-09-16)
- "Here’s Why Fifth Harmony Fans Think the Girl Group Is Making a Comeback Ahead of Anniversary" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-09-20)
- "NCT 127 Open 10th-Anniversary ‘Neo City: The Redline’ Tour With Sold-Out Seoul Run" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-09-22)
- "1Retro adds cloud saves to RetroArch, OpenEmu, and other gaming platforms" (www.techspot.com, banked 2026-09-22)
- "NCT 127 Open 10th-Anniversary ‘Neo City: The Redline’ Tour With Sold-Out Seoul Run" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-09-23)

Newly banked this run:
- THROWBACK THURSDAY: "NCT 127 Open 10th-Anniversary ‘Neo City: The Redline’ Tour With Sold-Out Seoul Run"

SOURCES SKIPPED THIS RUN:

- @CBCNews (fetch failed)
- @globalnews (fetch failed)
- @Gizmodo (no posts cleared the 30+ likes bar - 5 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)
- Morning Brew (OpenCLI browser-scrape returned nothing - check Chrome/bridge)

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